

younger siblings. They got an apartment together, one bus ride away from campus because as a student, Grace could get a free bus pass. Her family's food stamps also eased some of her college food costs. She's taking advantage of every opportunity to save money. "I've been poor my whole life, so I was really really good at that," she said.

When I put a call out on Twitter for this book, looking for millennials of color doing unpaid internships, it wasn't middle- to upper-class kids who emailed me. It was mostly women like Grace, who fit Aronowitz's profile of the forgotten lower-income millennial. Midway through our Skype conversation, Grace had to check if we got disconnected because her Internet bill wasn't paid that month. These types of financial problems don't mesh with *Time* writer Joel Stein's portrait of a whining twenty-something who wants endless vacation days at work and to eat overpriced avocado toast everyday. The middle class is millennial. The poor are apparently just a permanent underclass. That needs to change.



TAKEAWAYS

- ° Take everything you hear about millennials or any other generation with a grain of salt (yes, even the stuff in this book). The generalizations often don't consider the full diversity of these populations.
- ° Be open about your own money foibles with your friends your own age and with the older and younger people you know. Tell them the errors of your (and society's) ways. They are learning from our mistakes—and we can learn new money techniques from them too.
- ° Stop ragging on millennials as some mysterious terrible monolith. We're sorry we're not spending as much on cereal or diamonds or whatever, the way previous generations did. We inherited a shitshow.